PURDUE UNIVERSITY | Mitch Daniels School of Business

ECON 25200-Y02 (CRN 25718)
Macroeconomics
Summer 2026

Instructor

Andres J. Vargas
Synchronous Sessions/ Office Hours: Thursdays, 1:30 pm – 3:00 pm ET, or by appointment
Phone: 765-496-2862
Zoom Meeting ID: 980 4196 9526
Email: vargas28@purdue.edu. Please write ECON 25200-Y01 in the subject line.

Teaching Assistant

Mark Strayer
Virtual Office Hours: Wednesdays, 6:00–7:30 pm ET, or by appointment
Zoom Meeting ID: https://purdue-edu.zoom.us/my/markstrayer.purdue
Email: strayerm@purdue.edu. Please write ECON 25200-Y01 in the subject line.

Course Description

This course examines how the US economy functions and develops a theoretical framework permitting an analysis of the forces affecting national income, employment, unemployment, interest rates, the rate of inflation, and exchange rates. Emphasis is placed upon the role of government's fiscal and monetary policy in promoting economic growth and stable prices. Topics covered include economic methods and questions; optimization; aggregate supply and demand; macroeconomic measures; aggregate income; economic growth; employment and unemployment; money and banking; macroeconomic stabilization techniques; international trade; and open economy macroeconomics.

Course Outcomes

Students successfully completing the course should be able to:

- Incorporate the essential principles of economic analysis into your own decision-making process.
- Identify the fundamentals of supply and demand in a competitive market and explain how the equilibrium price and quantity are determined.
- Describe the macroeconomy using aggregate measures.
- Identify and describe the proximate and fundamental causes of economic prosperity.
- Distinguish the different measures, causes and effects of unemployment.
- Recognize the causes and effects of inflation.
- Categorize and describe the causes and properties of business cycles.
- Analyze and evaluate monetary and fiscal policy tools as they relate to economic stabilization.
- Explain how comparative advantage provides the basis for gains through trade.
- Describe how exchange rates are determined.
- Critically assess economic information contained in news reports, policymakers' statements, and specialized publications.

Class Web Page

Students should check Brightspace for information about the class. https://purdue.brightspace.com/d2l/login . It is strongly recommended that students install **Brightspace Pulse**, a mobile app that can help you stay connected and on track with your Brightspace courses.

Technical Requirements

The following information has been provided to assist you in preparing to use technology successfully.

- Internet access/connection: high speed recommended
- Headset/Microphone (if required for synchronous sessions in an online course)
- Webcam (internal or external)
- Mobile Device (phone/tablet): The device must be able to scan a QR code.
- A computer with a Windows or Mac Operating System,
- MyEconlab for homework assignments

Learning Resources & Texts

Required Textbook:

Macroeconomics**,** Pearson, third edition, by Acemoglu, Laibson and List with MyEconlab for e-text, online homework, exams and dynamic study modules. ISBN-13: 9780136662198

Instructor's Online Hours

I will be available and respond to student questions as soon as I am available (generally 24 hours) during the M-F work week. Student inquiries made during the weekend may experience a delayed response time.

- For questions about specific homework assignments use the "**Ask My Instructor**" button embedded within MyEconLab. Due dates will not be extended, so please start your assignments early so that you have enough time to ask questions and receive a response before the due date/time.

- Questions about the course content, digital interactives, or lectures should be asked in the Q&A forum provided on the **Brightspace Discussion Board**. Students are encouraged to answer the questions their peers ask on the Q&A forum.

- **Email** should only be used for personal questions. When emailing me, please place the course number in the subject line of the email. This will help me tremendously in locating your emails quicker.

Virtual Office Hours

Virtual Office Hours are a synchronous session (through Zoom) to discuss questions related to the course content. The instructor office hours will be Thursdays 1:30 pm – 3:00 pm ET, or by appointment. Students are encouraged to enroll live and participate in the activity with their colleagues. For those students who are not able to attend, the sessions will be recorded and be available later.

The teaching assistant office hours will be Tuesdays from 7:30 pm – 9:00 pm ET, or by appointment.

Course Requirements and Assessment

Outcome Assessments	Points
Homework Assignments	60 points
Midterm 1: May 26	80 points
Midterm 2: June 3	80 points
Final Exam: June 12th - June 14th	80 points
Total	**300 points**

Grading

All the grades will be posted on Brightspace and MyEconLab**.** If you think that a grading error was made, **you may submit an appeal within a week (7 days) of when the grade was returned to you**. Your written appeal should be based on course materials and should stress the validity of your original response. In grading (and re-grading) we will strive for fairness and consistency.

Grading Scale

In this class grades reflect the sum of your achievement throughout the semester. You will accumulate points as described in the assessments portion above. At the end of the semester, final grades will be calculated by adding the **total points** earned and translating those numbers (out of 300) into the following letter grades (there will be no rounding).

Point Range			Letter Grade	Point Range			Letter Grade
291.00	-	300	A+	231.00	-	239.99	C+
276.00	-	290.99	A	216.00	-	230.99	C
270.00	-	275.99	A-	210.00	-	215.99	C-
261.00	-	269.99	B+	201.00	-	209.99	D+
246.00	-	260.99	B	186.00	-	200.99	D
240.00	-	245.99	B-	180.00	-	185.99	D-
				0.00	-	179.99	F

Note: For Pre-DSB majors or students looking to change their major into the Daniels School of Business (CODO), ECON 25200 is a required course in the Economics Admissions Index (EAI). All EAI courses need a minimum C- or higher. Please consult with your advisor on additional requirements for Upper Division.

Homework Assignments Policies

There will be 11 homework assignments during the summer session. ***I will drop the lowest homework score and the average of the remaining 10 will count 60 points towards your final grade, or 6 points each.*** For example, if the average score of your best 10 assignments is 90%, you would receive (0.90 x 60) = 54 out of the 60 possible points for homework. Homework assignments will be posted on MyEconLab**.** The due date for each assignment will be clearly visible on MyEconLab and Brightspace and is also specified on the course

schedule (see below). **Because the lowest homework grade is dropped, late assignments will not be accepted and you will not be allowed to make up any homework assignments you miss for any reason.**

Students should be prepared to spend substantial time on reading and homework assignments. The course starts out at a fast pace and builds on what you learn. Thus, **I strongly recommend reading the textbook and solving the homework assigned concurrent with the topics discussed in the video lectures**. The homework assignments are designed to help you use the ideas presented in class to analyze current events on the news, to lead you through an investigation of some concept, and to give you an idea of the kind of questions you will find on the exams. The homework assignments will be a combination of multiple choice, graphing, fill-in-the-blank questions and digital interactives. Some of the questions are designed to be challenging. Others are routine. Do not be disappointed if you cannot do all of the problems correctly when you first set out to do them. You will find that it takes practice to develop the ability for solving problems. **You must finish and submit the digital interactives portion of the homework before the specified deadlines to receive credit for them. Incomplete, unsubmitted interactives will receive a score of zero.**

Some of the homework questions will ask you the read news articles from the New York Times, the Washington Post, The Economist and other news outlets. **Students at the Purdue University West Lafayette campus have free access to The New York Times:**
https://guides.lib.purdue.edu/c.php?g=1181458&p=8639188

Other news outlets are also accessible through the Purdue libraries. For example:

- **The New York Times articles are available at:** https://search-proquest-com.ezproxy.lib.purdue.edu/publication/11561/citation?accountid=13360.
- **The Economist articles are available at:** https://search.proquest.com/publication/41716?accountid=13360.
- **The Washington Post articles are available at:** https://search-proquest-com.ezproxy.lib.purdue.edu/publication/2042186/citation/440605C7B4854316PQ/2?accountid=13360
- **The Wall Street Journal articles are available at:** https://search-proquest-com.ezproxy.lib.purdue.edu/publication/10482/citation/47F915FC5614A51PQ/2?accountid=13360

MyEconLab will **give you three attempts** for most homework problem and will provide feedback based on the answers you submit. The drop-down questions with only two options won't give you three attempts. Multiple questions related to some news articles, where the answer is clearly stated in the news article won't give you three attempts. Finally, questions that ask you to check all that apply won't give you three attempts. Given the multiple attempts, the average score on each assignment should be close to 100%. Feel free to email me with any homework questions through the "***Ask My Instructor***" icon on a given homework question. I'll answer that e-mail within 24 hours, but **any questions sent after 7:00 pm ET will be answered the next day**.

You must register for *MyEconLab* through *Brightspace*, or your homework grades will not be included in your course point total. Click the MyEconLab link on the Brightspace page of ECON 252 and follow the instructions for registration from the Course Home link. Once you have registered for MyEconLab through Brightspace, you can complete homework assignments by linking to MyEconLab through Brightspace or by going directly to www.myeconlab.com.

If you buy a textbook from Purdue bookstores that is bundled with an access code, you will use that access code during registration. If you prefer to purchase access to the homework separately, you will purchase that access during the registration process. You should not have to pay for a textbook bundled with an access code AND purchase online homework separately. If you need product support for the online homework system, Pearson also offers a 24/7 Customer Technical Support at 247pearsoned.custhelp.com.

Exam Policies

There are two mid-term exams. Each mid-term counts 80 points of your final grade. The final exam also counts 80 points of your final grade. These exams will be in Brightspace during the times specified on the course schedule. The exams are open notes exams, but they are a **NON-COLLABORATIVE ACTIVITY**. You may not discuss it in any way with anyone until the exam period is over. Students are not permitted to use other classmates for assistance or the internet.

We will be using Respondus Monitor, an automated proctoring service available 24/7 that does not require scheduling. Respondus Monitor is used to capture the audio and video of students while they take their exams and requires the use of Respondus Lock Down Browser. Respondus Monitor allows a student to take a proctored exam at any time of day outside of a traditional testing center. **To be able to take the exams, you will need a computer with a Windows or Mac operating system and a webcam plus a camera from a mobile device (phone, tablet). The second device must be able to scan a QR code.**

Make-up examinations: The student needs to inform the instructor of any conflict that can be anticipated and will affect the ability to take an exam. Failing to take a scheduled examination will result in a score of 0 unless replaced by a make-up exam in a timely fashion. 'Make-up' examinations are given at the discretion of the instructor, and will only be given in cases where there is a documented excuse beyond your reasonable control:

- Illness – You have to communicate with me to indicate that you are not in a physical condition to take the exam at the scheduled time.
- Death or grave illness in your immediate family. (Please contact the Dean of Students to confirm the family emergency)
- Significant scheduling conflicts such as job interviews, exams for other courses scheduled at the same time. In this case, you must inform the instructor before the scheduled exam you may miss so that an alternate exam time can be scheduled.

No exam will be made-up after it has been graded and returned to the class.

When conflicts can be anticipated, such as for many University sponsored activities and religious observations, the student should inform the instructor of the situation as far in advance as possible. For unanticipated or emergency conflict, when advance notification to an instructor is not possible, the student should contact the instructor as soon as possible by email, through the LMS, or by phone. When the student is unable to make direct contact with the instructor and is unable to leave word with the instructor's department because of circumstances beyond the student's control, and in cases of bereavement, quarantine, or isolation, the student or the student's representative should contact the Office of the Dean of Students via email or phone at 765-494-1747. Our course Brightspace includes a link on Attendance and Grief Absence policies under the University Policies menu.

Participation Extra-Credit Points: Yellowdig

Yellowdig is an online conversation platform for our course. You will receive up to **14 extra-credit** points for participating in Yellowdig conversations. Each week, you can earn up to 1,250 Yellowdig points. To get a all 14 extra-credit points, you must have at least 4,000 Yellowdig points by the end of the summer session, or about 1,000 points per week. If you reach the weekly max by the end of each week, you are guaranteed to get a perfect score in Yellowdig and receive all 14 extra-credit points. The grading period for Yellowdig will begin on May 18th and end on June 14th.

You receive Yellowdig points for interacting and engaging with your peers in the following ways:

Writing a new Post of less than 40 words (50 points)
Writing a new Post of at least 40 words (280 points)
Writing a Comment of less than 20 words (50 points)
Writing a Comment of at least 20 words (210 points)
Receiving a Comment on your Post (70 points)
Adding a video in a post or comment (75 points)
Receiving a Reaction on your Post or Comment (55 points)

You are encouraged to reward your peers for producing excellent content by commenting on and reacting to their Posts. In addition, I will reward particularly exemplary Posts and Comments by giving Accolades. To earn as many points as possible, you are strongly encouraged to contribute to our Yellowdig Community early and often. Just keep in mind that, once you reach the weekly max, you cannot earn additional points until the weekly reset deadline (11:59 pm ET Sunday).

Yellowdig passes back your Yellowdig grade to Brightspace as a proportion that represents your current pace toward getting a perfect score in Yellowdig. Therefore, the points you see in Yellowdig might not match the points you see in Brightspace. If any of this confuses you, just remember: if you end every week with a Yellowdig grade of 100%, you are guaranteed to get a perfect score in Yellowdig, and will receive all 14 extra-credit points.

Course Evaluation

At the end of the summer session, you will be provided with an opportunity to evaluate this course and your instructor. Purdue now uses an online course evaluation system. You will receive an official email from evaluation administrators with a link to the online evaluation site. Your participation is an integral part of this course, and your feedback is vital to improving education at Purdue University.

I strongly urge you to participate in the evaluation system. I will give one bonus points to the whole class if the response rate to the students' evaluations of the course is higher than 67%.

There is a maximum of 15 bonus points that a student can earn during the summer session.

General Guidelines for AI Tool Usage

This course is committed to leveraging the latest technological advancements, including Artificial Intelligence (AI), to enhance the educational experience. However, it is crucial to use these tools in a way that supports learning objectives without compromising academic integrity and the development of individual analytical skills. **AI-generated content, particularly from Large Language Models like ChatGPT, is not permitted for use in Yellowdig and Exams**. This policy ensures the preservation of academic integrity and the authenticity of student work. Students are encouraged to approach AI as a supplementary tool that enhances, rather than replaces, their critical thinking and analytical skills in economics

Netiquette

You are encouraged to comment, question, or critique ideas. However, be mindful that sarcasm and humor can be easily misconstrued in online interactions. Please read the Netiquette rules for this course:

- Give other students the opportunity to join in the discussion.
- Present ideas appropriately.
- Be cautious in using Internet language. For example, do not capitalize all letters since this suggests shouting.
- Avoid using vernacular and/or slang language. This could possibly lead to misinterpretation.
- Keep an “open-mind” and be willing to express even your minority opinion.
- Think and edit before you share (e.g., post or email).
- Ask for feedback.

Academic Dishonesty

Purdue prohibits "dishonesty in connection with any University activity. Cheating, plagiarism, or knowingly furnishing false information to the University are examples of dishonesty." [Part 5, Section III-B-2-a, University Regulations] Furthermore, the University Senate has stipulated that "the commitment of acts of cheating, lying, and deceit in any of their diverse forms (such as the use of substitutes for taking examinations, the use of illegal cribs, plagiarism, and copying during examinations) is dishonest and must not be tolerated. Moreover, knowingly to aid and abet, directly or indirectly, other parties in committing dishonest acts is in itself dishonest." [University Senate Document 72-18, December 15, 1972]

Emergency Statement

In the event of a major campus emergency, course requirements, deadlines and grading percentages are subject to changes that may be necessitated by a revised semester calendar or other circumstances beyond the instructor’s control. Relevant changes to this course will be posted onto the course website or can be obtained by contacting the instructors or TAs via email or phone. <u>You are expected to read your @purdue.edu email on a frequent basis.</u>

Accessibility

Purdue University strives to make learning experiences accessible to all participants. If you anticipate or experience physical or academic barriers based on disability, you are welcome to let me know so that we can discuss options. You are also encouraged to contact the Disability Resource Center at: drc@purdue.edu or by phone at 765-494-1247.

Disability Statement

Students with disabilities must be registered with Disability Resource Center in the Office of the Dean of Students before classroom accommodations can be provided. If you are eligible for academic accommodations because you have a documented disability that will impact your work in this class, please schedule an appointment with me as soon as possible to discuss your needs.

Nondiscrimination

Purdue University is committed to maintaining a community which recognizes and values the inherent worth and dignity of every person; fosters tolerance, sensitivity, understanding, and mutual respect among its members; and encourages each individual to strive to reach his or her own potential. In pursuit of its goal of academic excellence, the University seeks to develop and nurture diversity. Purdue University prohibits discrimination against any member of the University community on the basis of race, religion, color, sex, age, national origin or ancestry, genetic information, marital status, parental status, sexual orientation, gender identity and expression, disability, or status as a veteran. Any student who believes they have been discriminated against may visit www.purdue.edu/report-hate to submit a complaint to the Office of Institutional Equity. Information may be reported anonymously.

Religious, Ethnic, and Civic Observances

Holidays or days of religious observance sometimes conflict with class and examination schedules. Students that miss course work due to the observance of a religious holiday will be given the opportunity to complete the work missed within a reasonable time after the absence. Notification must be made in writing and delivered to the instructor no later than the 15th class day of the semester.

Use of Copyrighted Materials

According to University regulations, lectures, notes, exams, and other material presented in class or as part of the course are protected by copyright. Students enrolled in the course are permitted to take notes, which they may use for individual/group study or for other non-commercial purposes reasonably arising from enrollment in the course. However, *no individual is permitted to sell or otherwise barter notes homework assignments, or exams, either to other students or to any commercial concern*, for a course without the express written permission of the course instructor.

Violent Behavior Policy

Purdue University is committed to providing a safe and secure campus environment for members of the university community. Purdue strives to create an educational environment for students and a work environment for employees that promote educational and career goals. Violent Behavior impedes such goals.

Therefore, Violent Behavior is prohibited in or on any University Facility or while participating in any university activity.

Counseling Services

Purdue University is committed to advancing the mental health and well-being of its students.

If you find yourself beginning to feel some stress, anxiety and/or feeling slightly overwhelmed, try WellTrack**, https://purdue.welltrack.com/.** Sign in and find information and tools at your fingertips, available to you at any time.

If you need support and information about options and resources, please see the Office of the Dean of Students, http://www.purdue.edu/odos, for drop-in hours (M-F, 8 am- 5 pm).

If you're struggling and need mental health services: If you or someone you know is feeling overwhelmed, depressed, and/or in need of mental health support, services are available. For help, such individuals should contact Counseling and Psychological Services (CAPS) at (765)494-6995 and http://www.purdue.edu/caps/ during and after hours, on weekends and holidays, or by going to the CAPS office of the second floor of the Purdue University Student Health Center (PUSH) during business hours.

Emergency Statement

In the event of a major campus emergency, course requirements, deadlines and grading percentages are subject to changes that may be necessitated by a revised semester calendar or other circumstances. All changes will be communicated through Brightspace.

Basic Needs Security:

Any student who faces challenges securing their food or housing and believes this may affect their performance in the course is urged to contact the Dean of Students for support. There is no appointment needed and Student Support Services is available to serve students 8 a.m.-5 p.m. Monday through Friday., students may submit requests for emergency assistance from the Critical Needs Fund. Students facing challenges securing their basic needs may submit requests for emergency assistance from the Critical Needs Fund.

PURDUE UNIVERSITY | Mitch Daniels School of Business

Course Schedule

ECON 25200 - Macroeconomics

Class Schedule - Summer 2026

Week	Date	Topic Covered/ Class Activity	Assignments Due
1	18-May	Introduction, Chapter 1-3: The Principles and Practice of Economics	
	19-May	Chapter 4: Demand, Supply, and Equilibrium	HW #1 due at 11:59 pm
	20-May	Chapter 5: The Wealth of Nations: Macroeconomic Aggregates	HW #2 due at 11:59 pm
	21-May	Chapter 6: Aggregate Incomes	HW #3 due at 11:59 pm
	22-May	Catch up and Review before Midterm 1 covering chapters 1- 6	HW #4 due at 11:59 pm
2	25-May	Memorial Day: No Class	
	26-May	**Midterm Exam 1**	Exam due at 11:59 PM ET
	27-May	Chapter 7: Economic Growth	
	28-May	Chapter 8: Why isn't the whole world Developed?	
	29-May	Chapter 9: Employment and Unemployment	HW #5 due at 11:59 pm
3	1-Jun	Chapter 10: Credit Markets	HW #6 due at 11:59 pm
	2-Jun	Catch up and Review before Midterm 2 covering chapters 7 -10	HW #7 due at 11:59 pm
	3-Jun	**Midterm Exam 2**	Exam due at 11:59 PM ET
	4-Jun	Chapter 11: The Monetary System	
	5-Jun	Chapter 12: Short Run Fluctuations	HW #8 due at 11:59 pm
4	8-Jun	Chapter 13: Countercyclical Macroeconomic Policy	HW #9 due at 11:59 pm
	9-Jun	Chapter 14:International Trade	HW #10 due at 11:59 pm
	10-Jun	Chapter 15: Open Economy	HW #11 due at 11:59 pm
	11-Jun	Catch up and Review before Final Exam covering chapters 11-15	
	12-Jun	**Final Exam Window 6/12/2026 12:01 AM - 6/14/2026 11:59 PM ET**	**FNL due 6/14 at 11:59 PM**

Note: All due dates and times are specified in Eastern Time (ET) the local time for West Lafayette, IN, where Purdue University is located. It is your responsibility to understand what this means and how it corresponds to your own time zone.